

ROAD TO YOUR FIRST GRAD OFFER

IN AUSTRALIA



STAGE 1: VISIBILITY



Based on:

- Conversations with 500+ students/grads
- 30+ offers secured across Tech/Business/Engineering

YOU ARE HERE

STAGE 1: VISIBILITY



STAGE 1: APPLICATION		
JOB'S APPLIED	10-150	
INTERVIEWS	0-3 (The furthest you have gone is recorded interview stages/screening call)	
# OF PEOPLE HERE CURRENTLY	120,000 (45% of University Students in Australia [International + Domestic students in their Last Year] are here now)	
	CONSTRAINTS	TO ADVANCE TO NEXT STAGE
HOW COMPETITIVE AS A CANDIDATE	You currently have 3 out of 6 things here: - Relevant Internship Experience - Society Executive Role 85+ WAM / Relevant Professional Certificates - Relevant Passion Project - Unique Personal Story - Australia Job Experience (can be casual roles/volunteering) But you don't know how to express them to maximise your chance to stand out	You are fully able to use these features of a strong candidate across your applications, from Resume, LinkedIn, to initial interviews
RESUME	You have a resume for your ideal role, but you get screened out most of the times	Have a well formatted resume and a few components/experience that makes you stand out, within the 10 seconds of the recruiter viewing
COVER LETTER	You have either use AI to generate generic cover letters, or tried hand writing, but the applications are still screened out	You leverage AI to produce a unique cover letter, that is concise and relevant
LINKEDIN	You have an account, a profile picture, and some bare experience. But you have no idea if it is up to standard.	Your LinkedIn clearly shows your ideal industry, and why you deserve a chance in that industry, in a concise manner

STAGE 2: CONNECTIONS		
+ possibly 1-2 in person interview done)		
Students in Australia [International + Domestic students in their Last Year] are here now)		
	CONSTRAINTS	TO ADVANCE TO NEXT STAGE
	Only and rarely, only once every 3 months	Have 1 screening call/interview at least once every 3 weeks
	Through platforms like LinkedIn, or Portal. Never through referral	Get 1 referral / introduction from someone in the company that you are applying to
	recruiters, but very rarely get a	Reached out and have at least 3 calls/coffee chats with industry professionals, that are not recruiters/HR.
	to peers from Uni who you don't (actions)	Connected to 150+ industry professionals in your desired industry. Attempted to reach out to ALL of them.

STAGE 0: FOUNDATION		
JOB'S APPLIED	0-50	
INTERVIEWS	0-2 (The furthest you have gone is recorded interview stages/screening call)	
# OF PEOPLE HERE CURRENTLY	80,000 (30% of University Students in Australia [International + Domestic students in their Last Year] are here now)	
	CONSTRAINTS	TO ADVANCE TO NEXT STAGE
CANDIDATE - HOW IMPRESSIVE ARE YOU AS A CANDIDATE	You currently have less than 3 out of 6 things here: - Relevant Internship Experience - Society Executive Role 85+ WAM / Relevant Professional Certificates - Relevant Passion Project - Unique Personal Story - Australia Job Experience (can be casual roles/volunteering)	Achieve them in
RESUME	You have a basic resume but have no idea how to sell it out	Achieve them in
LINKEDIN	You set up an account a while ago, but only use it to apply for jobs. You don't have any experiences highlighted in your LinkedIn.	Achieve them in

0. FOUNDATION

1. VISIBILITY

2. CONNECTIONS

3. QUALIFIERS

4. FINAL BOSS



I got 4 offers as an International Student, but I also experienced this stage.

Fidel - Headstart Mentor

STAGE 1: VISIBILITY

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JOBS APPLIED	10 -150
# OF INTERVIEWS	Recorded Interviews: 0-5 Screening Calls: 0-3 F2F Interviews: 0-1
# OF PEOPLE HERE CURRENTLY	86,400 (30% of International + Domestic students studying Business/Tech/Engineering in their Last Year are here now)

	CONSTRAINTS	TO ADVANCE TO NEXT STAGE
HOW COMPETITIVE AS A CANDIDATE	You currently have 3 out of 6 things here: • Relevant Internship Experience • Society Executive Role • 85+ WAM / Relevant Professional Certificates • Relevant Passion Project • Unique Personal Story • Australia Job Experience (can be casual roles/volunteering) If you don't - skip to 'Appendix - Page 1' first!	You are fully able to use these features of a strong candidate across your applications, from Resume, LinkedIn, to initial interviews
RESUME	You have a resume for your ideal role, but you get screened out most of the times	Have a well formatted resume and a few components/experience that makes you stand out, within the 10 seconds of the recruiter viewing
COVER LETTER	You have either use AI to generate generic cover letters, or tried hand writing, but the applications are still screened out	You leverage AI to produce a unique cover letter, that is concise and relevant
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Think you are not a strong enough candidate? Head to 'Appendix - Page 1' to see if you have at least 3 out of 6 strong traits.

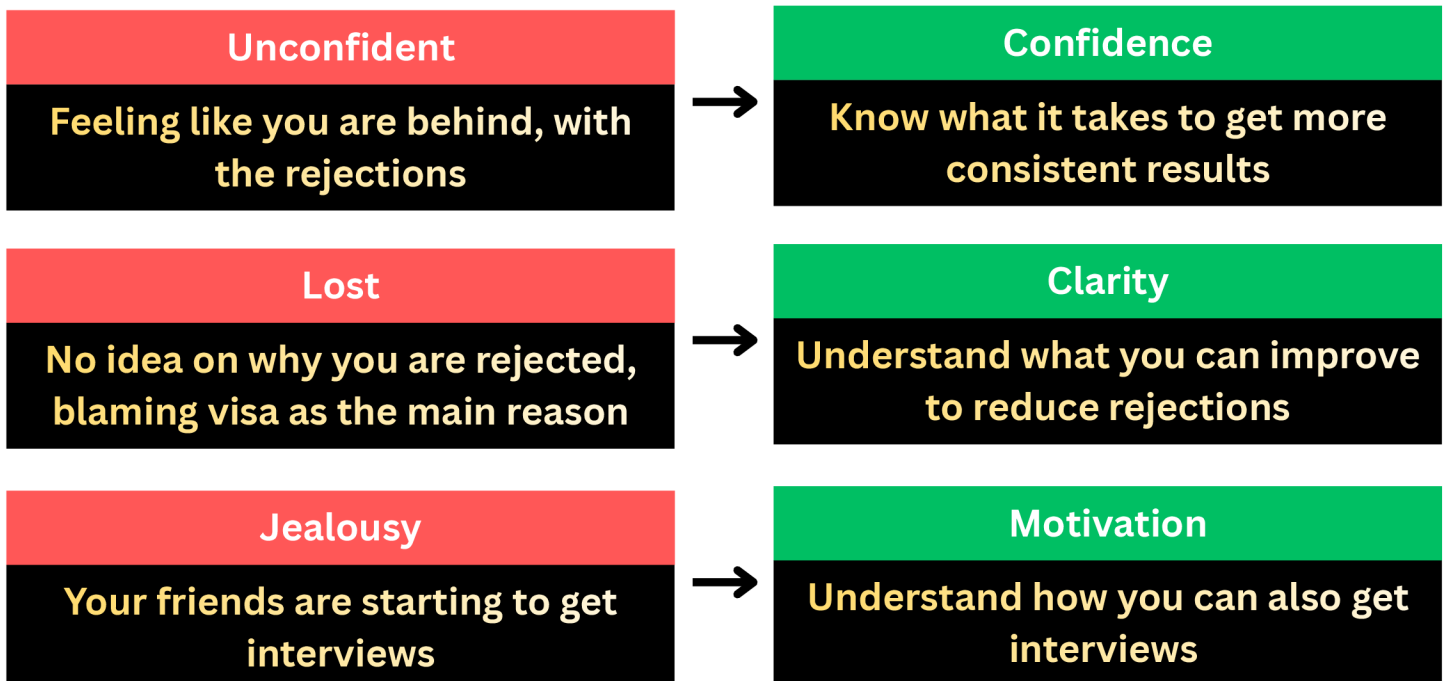
WHEN YOU ARE AT: “STAGE 1: APPLICATION”

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Welcome to Stage 1 - you are ready, or have already been trying to apply to jobs! **Your goal is simple: To have your resume, LinkedIn and cover letter that let's you stand out among the other 500 applicants.**

At this stage, you'd already have at least 3 traits of you that make you a strong candidate (check out [‘Appendix - Page 1’](#) if you aren't sure), now we just need to know how to present them across your application materials.

HERE'S HOW YOU ARE LIKELY FEELING RIGHT NOW AND HOW THIS DOC HELPS



The advice is based on:

- Conversations with 500+ students/grads
- 30+ offers secured by across Tech/Business/Engineering

RESUME



Before diving into specific tips, I want you to understand that there are 2 stages of your resume being reviewed:

1. ATS screening system (AI)
2. Human Eyes

The 2 **KEYS** to passing them

1. Have a resume that has an **abundance of relevant keywords to pass the ATS system**

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The ultimate hack is, rather than changing your whole resume for a specific job, we include most relevant key words in a professional profile section

Here's what you can do RIGHT NOW + in all future applications:

1. Paste the following prompt in any AI of your choice:

I want you to rewrite my professional profile based on the attached job description. Make sure to include all the key words that are aligned from my resume and the job description and bold most of the aligned keywords. Don't include skillsets that I totally don't have. I also want 1 line of reasons why I want to join the company in the job description, with a max word count of 15 words. If the company is a middleman (recruiting agency, recruiting platform), don't include the company name. This line would be in the same paragraph. Keep the professional profile to 4 lines, never add any em-dash. While this profile serves a goal of passing the ATS screening, make sure to not sound robotic, make it sound human by using first person words like 'I' but also be concise. I am going to attach both things now:

2. Copy the job description of the job you are applying, paste it in the same prompt

3. Copy your whole existing resume, paste it in the same prompt

2. Capture the recruiter's attention + impress them with the 10 seconds they have (they need to check 100+ resumes)

With such a limited time, recruiters would usually look at your experience first. Nailing the experience part gives you the BIGGEST leverage to impress them

Structure your EVERY bullet point of your resume RIGHT NOW, following this hierarchy:



Most ideal structure: 1 line of **HOW** you contribute to your role + 1 line of **quantifiable impact** that you (or your team) made, as a result of your contribution

Example 1:

Managed 2 end-to-end loyalty giveaway campaigns (100K+ members), coordinating internal teams and external film partner, resulting in a 3.1% uplift in weekly average transaction value.

Example 2:

Delivered weekly campaign tracking and analysis for Limited Time Offers, identifying mid-campaign sales decline and influencing cross functional team strategies that drove a 13.5% increase in sales units.

WHAT SHOULD I WRITE IF I DIDN'T MAKE ANY QUANTIFIABLE IMPACTS?



If impacts are hardly quantifiable, insert numbers to improve **context** of what you are doing.

Example 1:

Tracking promotional strategies from Nestle in 5+ grocery companies, drawing reports regarding effects of promotions.

Example 2:

Delivered quarterly 3+ brand performance updates to global partners, including Perfetti Van Melle (Mentos, Chupa Chups), translating panel and scan data into actionable commercial recommendations.

BUT I STILL DON'T HAVE ENOUGH THINGS TO INCLUDE



Match with one of our mentors in your industry to PERFECT your resume!

LINKEDIN



If you are able to convey your keenness to enter the industry + explain why you, but not the other 500 candidates in the applications, then you **WIN**.

The 2 KEYS to passing them

1. Showcase that you have a clear target field that you want to get into, in a **concise way**

1.1 Clear Messaging

Make sure to have **1 clear field** that you want to join. You want recruiters to be able to tell **RIGHT AWAY** that you are keen to join a certain field

EXAMPLE OF UNCLEAR PROFILES

- You had HR, marketing, finance experience and you put it all in your 'abouts page'
- You wrote that you are a founder of a start-up, but your goal is to get into a business analyst role
- You did a marketing internship, but you actually want a grad role in sustainability

→ They all give off an impression of you being undecided

1.2 Concise Messaging

Don't write more than 250 words in your abouts page - no one is reading that!

2. Clearly present **WHY YOU**, instead of the other 500 applicants

Secret Hack

Insert your most unique story + best career achievement in your 'abouts' section

I DON'T HAVE ANY UNIQUE STORIES, WHAT DO I DO?

Fun fact: You already have them. You just need a third opinion to validate and point out these unique stories. Here is a **practical step by step on how to extract them.**

1. Write down every single memorable activity you have done since High School to Today
2. Write down your target field (ie marketing / accounting / software engineer)
3. List out 2 memorable incidents per activity, that is related to your target field
4. Find a person that is already inside the industry / have an internship at least
5. Present your timeline to them to ask them to highlight what is interesting about yourself (If you cannot find that person - [we can help you](#))

Match with one of our mentors in your industry to PERFECT your LinkedIn!



COVER LETTER

Truth about cover letter is, more than half of the recruiters won't read them. So the objective here is to:

1. Write them efficiently
2. Make them concise in case recruiters do read them

Here's a structure that got **multiple offers** for Mentees and even Mentors, I have made it a prompt so you can plug it in AI, you have to do is insert this for every application:

- Your resume
- 1 unique fact about you
- The job description
- This prompt

Can you help me write a cover letter based on this format:

Hi Sir/Madam,

1st Paragraph: Quick intro and purpose of writing this letter.

[Insert 1 line on the purpose of this letter (to apply for the role), max 15 words]

[Insert 1 to 2 lines about the unique fact and how it links to the job]

[Here's what I can bring to the role]

2nd and 3rd Paragraph: Why I am a good fit for this role. Write 2 paragraphs covering 2 different skills.

Firstly, [Insert 1 line on a key skill I have that matches the job description, max 12 words, bold the key skill]

[Insert 1 to 2 lines on what I exactly did in my role that showcases that skill]

[Insert 1 line on impact (quantifiable) based on my contribution, bold the quantifiable impact]

4th Paragraph: Ending

[Insert 1 line showing keenness for a quick call to understand the hiring process]

Phone number | Gmail

Best regards,

[Name]

No em dashes, and the letter cannot be more than 200 words. Make sure the paragraphs are coherent, linking one paragraph to another. The "insert 1 line" is high-level guidance.

TO ADVANCE TO THE NEXT STAGE, YOU HAVE TO:

1. Have a well formatted **resume** and a few components/experience that makes you stand out, within the 10 seconds of the recruiter viewing
2. Clearly show your ideal industry on **LinkedIn**, and why you deserve a chance in that industry, in a concise manner
3. You leverage the provided AI prompt to produce a unique cover letter, that is concise and relevant

▶ **SECURE A SPOT FOR MENTORSHIP WITH US,
BEFORE YOUR COMPETITOR FINDS US!** ◀

TO BUILD THE FOUNDATION, YOU MUST AT LEAST **ACHIEVE 3 OUT OF 6** OF THE FOLLOWING FEATURES OF A STRONG CANDIDATE

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Based on:

- Conversations with 500+ students/grads
- 30+ offers secured across Tech/Business/Engineering

1. Relevant Internship Experience



- Local internship preferred; one from home country also works, as it builds employer confidence you can do the job
- This is the "**juice**" to your resume/LinkedIn
- Virtual internships (e.g. Forage) don't count as valid internship experience to most hirers

2. Society Executive Role



- Being an Executive = leading a function of the society, sometimes managing sub-committees
- Gives you "real world experience" distinct from internships

3. 85+ WAM / Relevant Professional Certificates / Wins in Case Competitions



- Grades matter only above 85+
- A relevant, widely recognized certificate (e.g. CFA for Finance, CISSP for Cyber Security) makes a difference
- Case comp wins count if top 3 or similarly notable

4. Relevant Passion Project



- Showcases proactivity and interest in the field
- Must have **direct impact** on your daily life or social circle, **preferably quantifiable**
- AI can help execute the project, but *direct impact is non-negotiable*

5. Unique Personal Story / Fun Facts



- Everyone has unique stories
- Unique stories make you memorable among hundreds of applicants
- 1-2 relevant fun facts about yourself can help you stand out immediately

6. Australia Job Experience (can be casual roles/volunteering)



- Local experience is **KING**, it shows you can communicate with people in Australia
- Casual or part-time work reassures employers on communication skills
- No job? Volunteering works too, if done consistently (e.g. once every 2 weeks)

**I DON'T HAVE 3 OUT OF 6
WHAT DO I DO?**



We understand all features are not easy to obtain in a short period of time, especially for society exec roles, internships, 85+ WAM. **However, don't be discouraged as there are 3 things we can start TODAY!**

Unique Personal Story / Fun Facts



Fun fact: You already have them. You just need a third opinion to validate and point out these unique stories. Here is a practical step by step on how to extract them.

1. Write down every single memorable activity you have done since High School to Today
2. Write down your target field (ie marketing / accounting / software engineer)
3. List out 2 memorable incidents per activity, that is related to your target field
4. Find a person that is already inside the industry / have an internship at least
5. Present your timeline to them to ask them to highlight what is interesting about yourself (If you cannot find that person - [we can help you](#))

Time Required: 2-4 hours

Where can you utilise these unique stories:

- LinkedIn 'abouts' page
- Resume professional profile
- Interview answers



Relevant Passion Project

Please understand your passion project should not be 'Generic AI Slop'.

Here are some idea avenues that are accepted across every field:

- Non-assignment related academic researches
- Technical tools that enhances your life / life of your social circle (ie A finance tracker)
- Blogs / Articles posted regularly
- Business Ideas to make money (has to be related to your field, or a part of business that has to use your particular skills in your field)

Time Required: 3-4 weeks

Where can you utilise these unique stories:

- LinkedIn + Resume Experiences
- Interview answers

Key to a successful passion project:



1. **Must generate an impact/results**, ie:

- saved \$ amount of money
- got x amount of user
- got x amount of likes of a social media post
- made x amount of money
- got recognition from professor

2. **You must have worked a combined of 20+ hours towards the passion project.**

When you work hard towards a project, you'd actually gain the confidence in your hard work, and this confidence is the **difference maker, especially during interview stages. Trust us, we have talked to 600+ mentees, recruiters, managers - and everyone can easily tell if your passion project is some 'AI slop' or the real deal.**

Want to make sure your passion project actually contributes to you being a strong candidate? [We provide real expertise from industry professionals that made it because of passion projects, through 1v1 mentorship.](#)

Australia Job Experience (can be casual / part time roles / volunteering)

Casual / Part time roles



How to get a casual / part time job, 3 ways, ranged from Easiest to Hardest:

1. Text every single friend of yours in Australia if their part time work place has any vacancies
2. Online applications
3. Print a resume of your past casual job history, go to the suburbs near you, walk in every shop and introduce yourself + ask if you can hand a resume to the manager

To understand deeper the difference between casual job applications, or what to include in a casual job resume. [Book a free call here](#) so we connect you to a mentor who previously did a part time job.

Time Required: 4-8 weeks

Where can you utilise this experience:

- LinkedIn + Resume Experiences
- Interview answers

Volunteering

To find volunteering activities that are available, insert this prompt to your LLM of choice:

Context: I live in [Insert suburb and state]. I'm building a candidacy for [Insert field].

Task: Find 5 volunteer opportunities that could strengthen this candidacy.

Criteria (all must apply):

- In or related to [Insert field]
- Involves teamwork: regular interaction/collaboration with other volunteers, not solo work
- Easy to get accepted (minimal vetting/interview process)
- Can start within 1 month from today
- Ongoing/regular commitment (not a one-off event)

Output format per option:

- Name + hyperlink
- 1-2 sentence description
- Acceptance difficulty rating (Easy / Medium / Hard, with a one-line reason why)